WP-4B-07: Second-nurse checks

Example General Hospital, Ward 4B. Version 3 (fictional). Owner: Ward 4B nurse in charge (fictional role).

FICTIONAL TRAINING DOCUMENT. Not clinical guidance. Example General Hospital is fictional.

Scope

Medicines on Ward 4B that need an independent check by a second registered nurse.

Medicines that need a second-nurse check

- Controlled drugs (see WP-4B-04).
- All intravenous medicines and infusions.
- Insulin.
- Any change to an anticoagulant dose.

How to perform an independent check

The second nurse checks the prescription, calculates the dose and checks the product without seeing the first nurse's result. Both results must match before the medicine is given.

Recording

Both nurses are recorded against the administration in MedTrack. The administration cannot be completed without the second nurse.

When no second nurse is available

Contact the nurse in charge, who arranges a second nurse from another ward. Do not give the medicine unchecked unless a delay would cause harm, and record the reason.